

Smart Devices



Consider how often you use your computing devices to access your personal data. Unless you have chosen to receive paper statements, you probably access digital copies of bank account statements via your bank's website. And when paying a bill, it's highly likely that you've transferred the required funds via a mobile banking app.

But besides allowing you to access your information, computing devices can now also generate information about you.

Wearable technologies such as smartwatches and activity trackers collect your data for clinical research, patient health monitoring, and fitness and wellbeing tracking. As the global fitness tracker market grows, so also does the risk to your personal data.

: > It might seem that information available online is free.
But is privacy the price we pay for this digital convenience?

For example, social media companies generate the majority of their income by selling targeted advertising based on customer data that has been mined using algorithms or formulas. Of course, these companies will argue that they are not 'selling' customer data, but 'sharing' customer data with their marketing partners.

You can make up your own mind!